07. Listening 1

Weather_7.1

Listen to Audio 1. Mark each sentence T (true) or F (false).

1. People began being interested in the weather a few decades ago. _____
2. A lot of beliefs are related to weather predictions. _____
3. If the sky is red in the evening, the weather will be fair the following morning. _____
4. Red sky in the evening means low pressure. _____
5. Birds need high air density. _____
6. Frogs are silent before a storm. _____
7. Frogs may croak louder to call mates. _____
8. Sheep run away when a storm is approaching. _____
9. Horses may be able to feel storms in advance. _____
10. There is no scientific proof that some animals can feel an oncoming earthquake in advance. _____



07. Listening 1

Weather_7.2

Listen to Audio 1. Match each given word/phrase 1-10 from the magazine article with a definition A-J.

1. Sayings	A proverb
2. Myths	B sexual partners of an animal
3. Shepherds	C putting down carefully
4. Adage	D a place that provides safety
5. Drops	E ideas that are commonly believed but are false
6. Refuge	F becomes lower
7. Croak	G people who look after sheep
8. Laying	H call
9. Summon	I commonly known, wise expressions
10. Mates	J make a characteristic sound

07. Listening 1 Keys

7.1	1F	2T	3T	4F	5T	6F	7T	8F	9F	10T
7.2	1I	2E	3G	4A	5F	6D	7J	8C	9H	10B

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07. Listening 1 Script

Red Sky At Night… - Audioscript 1

People have been aware of the importance of the weather ever since the beginning of history, and for centuries they have been trying to predict weather conditions.

Nowadays, science and high-tech can help us understand natural phenomena, including the weather, and to explain some sayings, beliefs, myths that have accumulated in this field. Here are some interesting examples.

A well-known old saying goes "Red sky at night, shepherds' delight, red sky at morning, shepherds' warning", with some variations. It means that a particularly red sky in the evening means good weather the following day, while a red sky in the morning means bad weather, usually rain or even a storm, the following morning.

It is easy to prove this century-old adage correct, and science can explain the reason: the sky is extremely red in the evening when it is full of particles and high pressure moves in, signifying stable weather; the opposite is true when the sky is red in the morning: low pressure is moving in and this means unstable weather.

Another common belief concerns birds and the weather: when birds fly high, the weather will be fair, but if they fly lower, usually bad weather is coming. An increase or decrease in pressure is involved also in this case: if the pressure drops, which is typical of oncoming storms, birds fly lower because they need a higher density to fly higher in the air. Some birds even stop flying, when they "feel" bad weather is coming, and take refuge.

07. Listening 1 Script

Frogs are also well-known "weather forecasters": these amphibians tend to croak exceptionally loud when (usually) heavy rain is approaching. A possible explanation is that they need fresh water for reproduction (for laying eggs, that is), so they probably croak louder before it rains because in this way they summon possible mates!

If you are in the country and you see a flock of sheep who are huddling close (which means staying close) to each other, you may want to go back home and put off any plans of walks in nature, because it will probably rain. This behaviour indicates that these creatures are preparing to protect each other against an oncoming storm, or at least this is what some people believe.

Finally, sometimes we hear that some animals, for instance horses or dogs, can feel an oncoming earthquake, and start behaving in unusual ways, like getting anxious or particularly nervous a few minutes before the event. Actually, science has never proven any connection between earthquakes and a specific behaviour or feeling in any animal, but this does not mean it isn't true!